Pakistan which belonged to the lower middle class. Officially, however, JeM denied its links and support from or to SSP.

In addition to SSP, JeM had close ideological, sectarian and strategic relationships with another ultra-militant sectarian organisation known as Lashkar-e-Jhangvi (LeJ). These links were based on the fact that both organisations had sectarian policies and recruited from the same type of people especially belonging to Deobandi madrasahs. This close relationship between SSP and JeM was also a factor in determining the intimate relationship between JeM and LeJ as the latter was considered a militant version of SSP (Mapping Militant Organisations, Jaish-e-Muhammad).

The JeM became a rival group of HuM, the main group from which Maulana Masood Azhar splintered to form its own new group. The main reasons were internal divisions and rivalries in the group, particularly on ethnic lines between its Punjabi members and other communities. This rivalry, however, did not become a practical major clash, as both the groups co-existed even though rank and file of HuM continued to leave it to join JeM. There were reports of minor clashes between the two groups over issues of assets in Pakistan-controlled Kashmir (Raman, 2001). Although they reached an agreement, this did not end the rivalry, and small clashes continued for some time until the government of Pakistan banned these organisations.

JeM employed different methods and tools in its operations depending on the objectives and situations. According to reports, JeM primarily carried out suicide bombings, which was one of the first organisations to begin suicide missions in Kashmir. The group was also reported to have links with sectarian killings against the minority Shiite community and Christians. In addition, JeM carried out attacks on the Pakistani state and some of the western targets inside Pakistan.

After the hijacking saga, Indian authorities declared JeM a terrorist organisation under the Prevention of Terrorism Act (POTA) on 25 October 2001. Later, in December 2001, the US Department of State also placed JeM in the list of foreign terrorist organisations. Due to international pressure to crackdown on militant organisations, Pakistan also declared JeM as a terrorist organisation and a number of its activists and leaders were detained or arrested (Kashmir Herald). JeM responded with attacks against the state of Pakistan, Christians and the minority Shiite community. Meanwhile, many of its activists joined hands with